

the anesthetic itself may sting. Although afterward it's common to experience uterine cramps, similar to menstruation cramps, rest assured that these alone do not mean that you have an increased risk of miscarriage.

If your blood type is [Rh negative \(Rh-\)](#), you should receive an injection of anti-Rh after the procedure to prevent complications from occurring during this and future pregnancies.

After the procedure

It's thought that being active after a CVS or amniocentesis does not increase your risk of miscarriage. However you may feel better if you don't exercise heavily right away; it's not necessary to remain in bed. In most cases, you should be physically able to return to work within a day or so after a diagnostic procedure, although emotionally you may want to return to work right away.

Getting the results

The initial results from both procedures are available within 48 hours and the result confirmed about two weeks later.

A COMPARISON BETWEEN CVS AND AMNIOCENTESIS

Before deciding which test to have, you should consider the advantages and disadvantages. Both tests carry a 0.5–1 in 100 risk of miscarriage, but there are other things to consider before making a decision.

CVS: the pros

- CVS can be done up to five weeks earlier than amniocentesis, so if an abnormality is found and you decide to terminate, it can be done in a safer, less traumatic way.
- Because more genetic material is collected, the results may arrive sooner, decreasing the anxious wait.

CVS: the cons

- The risk of miscarriage after CVS is higher than amniocentesis, because it is done at an earlier stage of gestation. The risk is the same for a [transabdominal and transvaginal procedure](#).
- In the past, some women who had a CVS had babies with limb abnormalities. These cases occurred when CVS was done before 10 weeks when the limbs were starting to form. The risk of limb defects without CVS is 1 in 1,700 and 1 in 1,000 with CVS.

Amniocentesis: the pros

- Amniocentesis is highly accurate.

Amniocentesis: the cons

- Since this is done later than CVS and the results may take longer, if you terminate you'll be induced and have a vaginal delivery.

AMNIOCENTESIS

During amniocentesis, the doctor uses ultrasound to locate an open pocket of amniotic fluid. Under continued ultrasound guidance, a thin needle is placed through the skin of the abdomen